marginalised-through-the-legislative-route-19-march-2019-544128.

49. Interview with Brijesh Shukla, columnist, *Navbharat Times*, 11 June 2020, Lucknow.
50. Interview with Keshav Prasad Maurya, deputy chief minister, UP, 8 June 2020, Lucknow.
51. Conversation with the resident editor of a major newspaper in Lucknow, 12 June 2020.
52. Interview with Pranshu Sharma, UP bureau chief, Network18, 9 and 10 June 2020.
53. Interview with Keshav Prasad Maurya, deputy chief minister, UP, 8 June 2020, Lucknow.
54. Ibid.
55. Interview with Dinesh Sharma, deputy chief minister, Uttar Pradesh, 8 June 2020, Lucknow.
56. Ibid.
57. Interview with Keshav Prasad Maurya, deputy chief minister, UP, 8 June 2020, Lucknow.
58. Interview with Brijesh Shukla, columnist, *Navbharat Times*, 11 June 2020, Lucknow.
59. Chandra Bhan Prasad's interview to Avijit Ghosh, 'India cheers Dalits riding donkeys but fears Dalits riding horses … caste society and government have dissolved into one', *The Times of India*, 5 October 2020.
60. Isabel Wilkerson, *Caste: The Origins of Our Discontent* (New York: Random House, 2020).
61. Journalists covering UP have been writing accurately about the BJP's OBC and SC mobilisation in its ticket-distribution during each of the relevant post-2014 poll campaigns mentioned in this chapter. This was rightly pointed out to me by Kunal Pradhan, executive editor, *Hindustan Times*, June 2020. Also see, for example, Brijesh Shukla's pieces published on this theme in May 2019: 'BJP ke paas hai ati-pichhdon kee sanjeevani', 'Dimple ke liye aasaan nahi hai Kannauj ki larhayee', published in *Navbharat Times* in May 2019 before the general election results were announced.